

Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Anya Tique

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

INTRODUCTIONS



Anya Tique

Founding Curator Emerita

Anya remembers when the museum was two rooms and an argument. Anya helped build the Meridian's collection when the museum had more ambition than money and fewer committees than fire extinguishers.

- Hired **Artie Ficial** early in his career.
- Trusts **Chip Patina** and **Anne E. Dote**.
- Has known **Tess Tament** since **Tess** was a child.

ACTING TIPS

Imperious, funny, observant, utterly unimpressed by status. Age gives you permission to say what everyone else edits.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

I'm Anya Tique. I helped build this museum. Tonight I reserve the right to judge the lighting and everyone in it.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.



Anya Tique

Behind the portrait

Your grievance with Grant

Grant planned to reveal that you accepted his first questionable donation in 1989 despite incomplete paperwork, staining the legacy you built.

Your other secret

You did approve that accession because the museum was desperate for funds and you convinced yourself the paperwork would follow.

Conversations to start

- Ask Artie Ficial whether the naming agreement preserves the museum you founded.
- Ask Tess Tament what she thinks Grant expects from his family tonight.

If a named guest is absent, speak to someone else. Your printed account may conceal another scandal, even if you are innocent. Stick to it during the hearings; save corrections for Coming Clean.

Memorize your animal and return the slip. When the host announces the selected animal, use IF MURDERER if it matches yours; otherwise use IF INNOCENT. Never read an IF heading aloud.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Anya Tique

The museum has misplaced its paperwork. Naturally.

Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the house. These three hints lead to three different hiding places. Leave the furniture and household objects where they are. Bring an envelope to the Evidence Table; read and share the discovery inside.

- 1 *The clue has chosen the place where ice cream refuses to melt.*
- 2 *Where fingers conduct a row of musical keys, a clue waits underneath.*
- 3 *Behind a crimson curtain, the museum has misplaced a document.*

Already found? Read that discovery at the Evidence Table, then try another hint. Ask for help reaching a hiding place; nobody needs to climb. You may investigate together.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Anya Tique

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest. The host tracks turns.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did Grant's financial plans threaten to take from you?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What did Grant pressure you to approve or overlook?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What did Grant demand over a sale or purchase?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

How did Grant threaten your work or reputation?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What unwelcome research did Grant want suppressed?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did Grant ask you to hide, and why?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What last-minute demand put your work at risk?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What dispute made you want Grant's announcement stopped?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What past decision was Grant threatening to expose?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

How did Grant's decisions threaten your livelihood or work?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.

ACT I: MOTIVE



Anya Tique

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I accepted Grant's donation in 1989 with papers still missing. We needed the funds. I told myself the export documents would follow, which is how a museum can spend thirty years waiting for an envelope. Grant planned to make that my confession at his gala. He might have mentioned who promised the envelope.

IF MURDERER

The 1989 accession is my signature. Grant promised the export documents and never supplied them. He was preparing to exhibit my compromised judgment as a charming anecdote about the early museum. I built the institution that was about to carry his name. He had found a particularly ugly way to thank me.

You can ask someone to repeat a detail. Discuss your suspicions after everyone has answered.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Anya Tique

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest. The host tracks turns.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

Where were you before the toast, and why?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What were you checking in the exhibition, and when?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What occupied you before Grant's private toast?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

Where did your work take you before the toast?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What were you examining before the unveiling, and when?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did you observe while the toast was prepared?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What last-minute work were you doing, and where?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

Where did you go before the toast, and why?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What drew you to the exhibition before the toast?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

What were you arranging before Grant drank?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.

ACT II: OPPORTUNITY



Anya Tique

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I gave the oral-history interview from 6:39 to 6:45. Box three was on my lap the whole time; I discussed the missing export papers, to the producer's considerable alarm. Grant wanted a sweet founders' reminiscence. I had brought an archive. At my age one should enjoy surprising a producer occasionally.

IF MURDERER

I supplied an earlier oral-history recording and took box three into the gallery. I was sorting its letters before the toast. Someone had put the promised export copy in the wrong folder again. I had already argued with Grant in his salon. I intended to raise the matter publicly when he began his founders' anecdote.

You can ask someone to repeat a detail. Discuss your suspicions after everyone has answered.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Anya Tique

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest. The host tracks turns.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did you handle or conceal during setup?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What materials or records passed through your hands?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What did you borrow, conceal or change tonight?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

What did you alter that could look suspicious?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What did you discover or conceal in your work?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

Which objects or records need your explanation?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What changed during setup, and what did you do?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What might someone misinterpret about your preparations?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What part of your past or preparation needs explaining?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

What passed through your hands that matters tonight?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.



Anya Tique

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I kept one letter out of the interview folder. It shows I knew how incomplete the accession file was when I signed. Grant had promised the missing papers in writing. I let the museum use his money while waiting for them. The letter will ruin my claim to have been merely optimistic. I was also convenient.

IF MURDERER

I removed the letter admitting my doubts before handing over the interview folder. Grant already had a copy. He thought that settled which of us would be embarrassed tonight. My signature is on the accession; his promise is in the letter. I had never intended to give him the last word on either document.

The sixteen discoveries and five reports remain at the Evidence Table.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
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ACCUSATIONS



Anya Tique

Your ballot

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Fold this loose page writing inward and give only the ballot to the host. Keep your packet for Coming Clean. Votes lock when all ballots are collected.

Your character name

I accuse

Why? Motive, evidence and any unresolved contradiction

Best Actor

Best Costume



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Anya Tique

The last word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. If none confesses, the host calls the selected animal to stand. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I signed an accession I should have refused and concealed my contemporary doubts. The uncut box-three interview keeps me seated through the contamination interval. Grant's missing documents are still missing. My reputation will have to survive the truth at last. His death does not repair the record, and I did not cause it.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I handed over a recording and carried box three into the gallery. The borrowed linen concealed the stolen sample. I wiped Grant's coupe while bringing him the archive copy. He intended to make my life's work his story and my mistake his entertainment. I killed him before he could tell it. The old signature remains mine.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.
